

# Facilitator Script — First Session with a Participant

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For whoever sits with a participant the first time they use Gap Sense. Follow it in order so every participant gets the same introduction. About 25 minutes.

Participants may be blind, low-vision, or DeafBlind. Say everything out loud. Do not point. Put the phone in their hand and guide their fingers when asked.

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## Before they arrive (5 min)

- ☐ Gap Sense installed on their phone, or on a loaner phone.
- ☐ In Accessibility: **Vibrate on cue** on. For a DeafBlind participant, set output to **Visual only, with no sound** and rely on vibration.
- ☐ Volume at about two-thirds. Silent switch position does not matter.
- ☐ Phone screen locks set to **Never** for the session, so the app does not go dark mid-exercise.
- ☐ The participant's crossing times entered in Settings (or their instructor's link opened), or example times loaded for a first session.
- ☐ This script, and the participant's consent form if your study uses one.

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## 1. Welcome (2 min)

Say:

"This app helps you learn how long your own street crossing takes. Not in

seconds. As a feeling in your body. It will never tell you a number. It plays

sounds and vibrations instead. There are no right or wrong answers today. We

are only interested in what you notice."

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## 2. Learn the three signals (3 min)

Open **Accessibility**, press **Test haptic pulse**. Say, as each plays:

"One knock. That is your own tap played back."

"Three knocks. That means you were close enough."

"One long buzz. That means you were too far off."

Play it twice more. Ask:

"Can you tell the three apart by touch alone?"

Record the answer: yes / no / partly. If no, try the phone in a different grip or against the wrist, and note what helped.

For hearing participants, also open **Help**, then **Run the sound tutorial**, and repeat with sounds.

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## 3. Where the times come from (1 min)

Say:

"The app already knows how long your crossing takes. Your instructor timed

it and set it. Today you will learn to feel that length of time."

If no real times exist yet, use **Try it now with example times** and say that these are examples.

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## 4. Part 1, Practise my timing (6 min)

Sit down. Say:

"Press the button. Imagine stepping off. Wait as long as you think your

crossing takes. Press again. Then listen to the space between the sounds."

Let them do at least eight attempts. After the fourth, ask:

"Are you counting, or feeling?"

If counting, say:

"Try to stop counting. Think of the walk instead. The feeling is the point."

Note roughly how many attempts until the three-knock signal becomes common.

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## 4b. Part 2, Time it from a signal (4 min)

Say:

"This time the app starts the clock. Press Ready and wait. When you feel two

quick blips, that is the start. Press again when you think your crossing

time is up."

Four to six rounds. If they press early, say: "That was before the signal. Nothing is saved. Press Ready again." Note whether the feeling holds without the rhythm of two taps.

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## 5. Part 3, Compare practice (5 min)

Say:

"You will hear a sample warning time: a sound that grows louder like a car

coming closer. Decide if it is shorter than your crossing, about the same,

or longer. Press the matching button, or swipe up for longer and down for

shorter. Then listen: both play together, and the space between the two

sounds is the difference."

Press **Play a sample warning time** for each round. Six to ten rounds. Note anything they say out loud about how they decide, and whether they use the buttons or the swipe pad.

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## 6. Wrap-up questions (3 min)

Ask and write down the answers in their own words:

1. "Which signal was easiest to feel? Which was hardest?"
2. "Did anything in the app confuse you?"
3. "Would you use this on your own, at home? Why or why not?"
4. "Is there anything you wish it did?"

Thank them. Remind them the app is theirs to keep practising with.

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## Common problems

| What happens                        | What to do                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No vibration                        | Accessibility, check <b>Vibrate on cue</b> is on. On iPhone, confirm it is the installed app, not Safari. |
| No sound                            | Volume buttons. The silent switch does not mute the app.                                                  |
| Buttons locked                      | Crossing times are not set. Enter them in Settings, open the instructor's link, or load example times.    |
| App will not open after some weeks  | TestFlight build expired. Tap the invite link again, press Install.                                       |
| Screen reader talks over the sounds | Normal. The app quietens the screen reader during playback on purpose.                                    |

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## What to send back to the research team

For each participant, in one message or spreadsheet row:

- date, participant code, phone type
- three-signals-by-touch: yes / no / partly, plus what helped
- attempts until "within margin" became common in Part 1, and whether it held in Part 2
- the four wrap-up answers, verbatim where possible
- anything that broke, with the exact words on screen